12-02 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Afternoon I Was a "Reading Big Sister" to Grade One

① On the second Wednesday of December, at exactly 14:10, I walked across the small covered bridge between our Grade 8 teaching block and the primary block of Lihua School. I had a cloth bag on my shoulder, two books inside — a **short illustrated book of Tang poems** my grandma gave me two winters ago, and an English picture book called *"The Small Bear Who Forgot His Name"*. I was going to be, for one hour, a **"Reading Big Sister"** to a Grade 1 class of twenty-seven children. Our literature teacher had asked three of us from the school literature club to try this new school scheme. I had said yes too quickly. Now, walking across the bridge, I was suddenly **seven kinds of nervous**: my hands felt cold, my bag felt heavy, and the small poem I had practised reading twelve times on the bus last night sounded silly in my head.

② The Grade 1 classroom had very small chairs and very loud children. Their teacher, Ms Xiang, smiled, clapped twice softly, and said, *"Children, this is Yiran-jiejie from Grade 8. She is going to read us two stories. She is a little nervous, so let's sit very still and help her, yes?"* The room went, magically, quiet. **Twenty-seven pairs of eyes**, bright and round, swung toward me. A small boy in the front row gave me a serious thumbs-up, as if I were about to jump off a cliff and needed courage. *Thank you, small boy.* I sat down on the tiny red chair at the front. My knees almost touched my chest.

③ I opened the illustrated Tang poems first. I had picked an easy one: Meng Haoran's *Spring Morning*. In slow, clear Chinese, I read the four lines: *Chūn mián bù jué xiǎo, chù chù wén tí niǎo. Yè lái fēng yǔ shēng, huā luò zhī duō shǎo.* I had expected some of them to fidget. Instead, their faces did something quiet and wonderful: they **listened with their whole bodies**. When I said "chù chù wén tí niǎo" — "birds calling in every place" — a little girl on the second row turned her head toward the window, as if looking for one. When I said "huā luò zhī duō shǎo" — "how many petals have fallen?" — I saw another child open his hand softly in his lap, palm up, as if to catch them. I had never, in twelve rehearsals, understood that line. Now, looking at that small open palm, I did.

④ Then I read the English picture book. My English is not bad, but reading aloud to children is, as I quickly discovered, a completely different skill. You must slow down by about **one-third**, you must change your voice a little for each animal, and you must hold the book flat at shoulder level so every child can see the pictures. I got that last part wrong twice, and a small girl in the corner raised her hand politely and said, *"Jiejie, I can't see the bear's hat."* I apologised. I lowered the book. The whole room leaned forward in the same slow wave. It felt, for a moment, like watching the tide come in.

⑤ After the story, Ms Xiang said, *"Would anyone like to ask Yiran-jiejie a question?"* Twelve hands went up. I braced myself. The first question, from a child in pink hair clips: *"Jiejie, do big sisters have homework?"* (Yes, lots. I tried not to sound too sad.) The second: *"Jiejie, what is your favourite colour when you were in Grade 1?"* (Deep green. They all nodded wisely.) The third question, from the serious thumbs-up boy in the front row, made me pause: *"Jiejie, when you were seven years old, what story did you love most? Could you tell me, so I can tell my little sister?"* I had not prepared for this. I thought for a moment, and I said that when I was seven, my favourite story was *"The Little Match Girl"*. The room went suddenly grave. "Is that a sad story, jiejie?" he asked, worried. *Yes*, I said, *but it is also a kind one. Sad stories teach us to be careful with each other.* He nodded slowly, almost too slowly for a seven-year-old, and wrote something down in a small notebook I had not noticed he was holding.

⑥ At the end, each child wrote me a thank-you card — two lines, simple crayon. The cards were beautifully wrong. One said: *"Deer Yiran-jiejie, thak you for the brids."* Another: *"I lowe the bear wiht hat."* A third: *"Next time plees read the petal poem again, I was listening very hard with my inside ears."* I did not laugh. I folded the cards very carefully and put them in my cloth bag, between the poem book and the picture book. I thought, *these are the most honest letters I have ever received.*

⑦ Walking back across the covered bridge at 15:40, I noticed that the bridge was, as usual, a little noisy. Four Grade 9 boys were arguing about a basketball score. A teacher on the phone was saying something about fees. Two Grade 5 girls were walking quickly, their schoolbags knocking against each other. And me — I was walking slowly, quietly, with a bag of crayon letters on my shoulder and a seven-year-old boy's quiet, careful question still sitting somewhere behind my ribs. *When you were seven, what story did you love most?* I realised that when I had been seven, nobody had ever asked me that question. He had just asked me — and in asking, he had given me the small shape of my own memory back.

⑧ That evening, at dinner, I told my mother the three Grade 1 questions. She listened carefully and said, *"Yiran, you went in as a reading big sister. What did you come out as?"* I thought. I said, slowly, *"Mom, I think I came out as a slightly older student."* She laughed quietly. *"Then it was a good afternoon."*

⑨ Later, before bed, I wrote five lines in my diary:

December 8th.
Grade 1, thirty-five minutes of reading, twenty-seven listeners.
They taught me: slow down, hold the book flat, let a small palm open itself under a line about fallen petals.
They taught me: "reading aloud" is really "listening aloud".
When I am seventy, I hope I still read like this.

Then I closed the notebook, put one of the crayon cards — the one about **"inside ears"** — into the front cover, and slept deeply, the way only people who have been listened to carefully by children can sleep.

注释： fidget 坐立不安；grave 严肃的；crayon 蜡笔；petal 花瓣；thumbs-up 竖起大拇指

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer walk across the covered bridge to the primary block at 14:10?

A. To borrow a book from the primary library.
B. To join a Grade 1 PE lesson.
C. Because she had agreed to be a "Reading Big Sister" for one hour to a Grade 1 class of twenty-seven children, taking a short illustrated book of Tang poems and an English picture book with her, under a new school scheme.
D. To hand in homework.

2. During the Tang-poem reading, what quiet thing did the writer notice about the Grade 1 children?

A. They got bored and left.
B. They played games under the desks.
C. They listened "with their whole bodies" — one girl turned her head toward the window when she heard "birds calling in every place"; another child opened his hand softly in his lap, palm up, when he heard "how many petals have fallen," as if to catch them.
D. They asked to change the story.

3. What did the serious thumbs-up boy in the front row ask the writer?

A. What her favourite colour was.
B. How to do Grade 8 homework.
C. When she was seven years old, what story she loved most, so he could tell it to his little sister; he wrote her answer down carefully in a small notebook.
D. Where she lived.

4. What did the writer's mother ask at dinner, and how did the writer answer?

A. Her mother asked about her marks; she said her marks went up.
B. Her mother asked, "You went in as a reading big sister. What did you come out as?" and the writer answered, slowly, "Mom, I think I came out as a slightly older student."
C. Her mother asked about a dress; she said it was blue.
D. Her mother asked about the teacher; she said Ms Xiang was strict.

5. What does the writer mainly realise through this afternoon?

A. That Grade 1 students are too noisy for a real lesson.
B. That reading aloud is hard and she will never do it again.
C. That "reading aloud" is really "listening aloud", and that small children, by listening with their whole bodies and by asking careful, quiet questions (like "when you were seven, what story did you love most?"), can give an older student the shape of her own memory back and make her come out as "a slightly older student."
D. That Tang poems are difficult for young children.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段背景
【解析】"读给一年级 / 两本书"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段"一整只身体在听"
【解析】"转头 / 掌心打开"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段问答
【解析】"你七岁时最爱的故事"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段餐桌对话
【解析】"进去作什么 / 出来作什么"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑦⑧⑨段总结
【解析】"朗读即听 + 小孩把记忆还给她"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。